

Knowing When to Say “Enough”

PRIMARY TEXT: GENESIS 2–3

For some of us this new lens we’re using is so freeing! The freedom to ask questions and wrestle—to see this as more than just a scientific lab report or history book. Because no matter how many times we’ve read or studied the Creation story, when we look at it through this new lens we are left with so many problems and questions—that lead to more questions!

Then there are those who don’t find this freeing; we find it terrifying and uncomfortable, and that it goes against how we were told we could look at the Bible. Meaning, you don’t ask. To do so would be a sign of our lack of faith, and how utterly embarrassing and *shameful* would that be?! Yet through this lens we are *supposed* to ask? Supposed to question and wrestle? The short answer being, yes—and there is no shame in that.

We were reminded of this “wrestling” in the prayer from last episode’s companion. “*God is bigger than our questions and greater than our worries...*” Perhaps we should make an addition. “... *He sits with us in our shame until we realize it is not where we belong.*”

**He sits with us in
our shame until we
realize that is not
where we belong.**

Adam and Eve messed up—as we continue to today—and so often we think this is where our story begins. We start with shame and sin instead of the goodness of creation. Instead of beginning with the earth that life was breathed into or the beautifully crafted, opposing forces that make humanity whole, we isolate and bury ourselves in our sin. Is this trusting the story, or is it trying to fix things by our own power? Are we not left missing the point and what Genesis

2–3 tells us about this God who loves us so very, very much?

So, whose voice are you listening to today?

A voice that tells you you’re not enough, or a voice that tells you you’re not alone?

A voice that sees your mistakes and replays them in your mind again and again and again, or one that helps you move beyond them?

A voice that tells you to do more, attain more, be more? Or a voice that tells you when to say enough?

**Whose voice
are you
listening to?**

This is not to say there's no need for repentance and forgiveness—we'll get there—but that is not the point of this story. God saw Adam and Eve in their nakedness—their guilt and shame. Yet He sits with them and asks them who they have been listening to. Who told them that they were naked—not enough? Then He clothes them. He meets them where they are at and prepares them for what's next in trusting the Story. God does not leave or abandon them. He continues to walk with them.

And He is doing this for you.

When you don't know when to say enough. When other voices begin to creep in making you forget you are a human being, not a human doing; take a deep breath, find the breeze in the cool of the day, and remember that breath—that wind, that spirit—is life. Let *El Shaddai* meet you where you're at and whisper to you when to say "enough."

**You are a
human being—
not a human
doing.**

PRAYER

*God,
Thank you for being the God
who walks with us in the cool of the day
and teaches us to trust that your Word is enough.
For being the God who meets us where we're at,
clothes us, and calls us Very Good.
May we carry this with us,
and see this goodness in others,
each and every day.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 2

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What piece of Genesis 2–3 could you meditate over and memorize this week? (Check out our YouVersion Reading Plans to help guide you.)



COMMUNITY

What intentional relationships help you practice unity and authenticity? Who can remind you, and whom can you remind, to listen to God's voice—not the world's?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who would be impacted by the reminder that their story doesn't begin in shame, but in goodness? How might you meet them where they are at and help them see themselves as an image bearer of God?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? Remember, questions are good! Questions were/are the point. What are you still wrestling with? What voices do you wrestle with? Are these voices of God or distraction/shame?



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*True success is developing intimacy with God, and **what peace it brings to know that God will meet us where we are at—even in our worst moments.** God knows your worth and wants you to remember it. What spaces do you have, or could you create, that make space for you to hear God's voice over others? Is this sacred devotional time, small groups, prayer, other spiritual disciplines?*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

*We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world. And they so often talk of their experience with church or faith as one where they were reminded of their shame more than the overwhelming love of Christ. **How can you remind young people of where their story truly begins as they also begin their career or new journey.** How could you remind them they are not a human doing, but human being?*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*This may be about what we do at work—yet it also has to do with how we choose to treat and see others. Do we see others in their mistakes, or do we see them in the image God created them? How we take advantage of or bring life to others is something God says is central to our presence in the world—and seeing them in His image is a vital first step. Does our physical work (our job) bring more chaos than shalom or set people up in failure? Does it exploit creation, or help us marvel in its goodness? The way we manage employees and interact with customers or coworkers says a lot about the God we believe in. **The work we do every day is sacred. It matters—and so does the belief in the potential of ourselves and others in this space.***